John Mahood School Council

Meeting Minutes September 17th, 2025

Present:

In Person:
Linda Cotnam
Laura Fehrenbach
Stephanie Rempel
Darrell Schinkel
Christine Martin
Alana Murray
Tabitha Nicholson
Kacheena Morrison
Betheny Metzger
Emily McConnell
Leah Cressman
Emily Martin
Mary Blanchard*

Online:
Meaghan Hachey
Alicia McGuire
Katie Armstrong

Voting Members Absent:

Cait Smith

Territorial Acknowledgement - Linda

Introductions - All

Discussion of Previous Minutes - Laura

- See last month's minutes Here
    - Accepted by - Laura
    - Seconded by - Darrell

Election of 2025-2026 School Council
Self Nominations
Chair: Laura Fehrenbach
Vice Chair: Mary Blanchard
Treasurer: Katie Armstrong
Social Media: Kaite Armstrong
Volunteer Coordinator: Darrell Schinkel
Fundraising Coordinator: Emily McConnel
Secretary: Alana Murray
Voting Members: ~~Natalie Anglin~~*, Bethany Metzger, Leah Cressman, Cait Smith, Tabatha Nicholson, Alicia McGuire, Stephanie Rempel, Meaghan Hachey, Kacheena Morrison,
Teacher: Christine Martin

Principal's Report - Linda

- Welcome, and thank you for the warm welcome, and for trusting us to care for your kids
- Linda's focus with council will be on student achievement and wellbeing of kids in the school
    - Share what's going on in school

    - Get advice of what should be done in the school
    - Share processes, and improvements in the school
    - Share board information
    - Goals are to hear our voices and share any information and policies
- Would like to get grade 6 reps as part of council - has had this at previous schools
    - Nice to get input from the students
    - No opposition from council, Linda will put feelers out
- SCIS - safe caring and inclusive schools committee
    - Involves staff member, community member, parent and several students
    - Meeting in October to plan for bullying prevention and intervention week in November
    - Has one parent lined up, will be taking more interested parents
    - Meetings are during the school day at nutrition break
- Nutrition break - all the kids out at the same time
    - Feedback from kids has been great
    - Concern for tarmac only recesses, will have no balls, possibly do some gym activities
- Working on final steps of interior renovations - should have been finished last friday, will be a few more weeks
    - Classrooms are functional, just minor finish up items eg. paper towel holders, etc.
- Weekly update via school-day - this is how Linda will regularly update
    - If a parent has questions, reach out to Linda
- Emergency supply teachers, emergency supply supervisors
    - Many interested parents, several candidates being interviewed
    - If by 6:30am there are no supply teachers who have taken a job, an emergency supply will be contacted
    - Unqualified - but it helps have someone in the building to support the students
- Bus patrols have started - 4 per bus
    - Bus patrol training tomorrow morning
- Trail blazers training on Friday
    - Will put together a map and send out to families
- Form went out to grade 6s for lunchroom helpers to help in primary classrooms
- Terry Fox family picnic

Chair's Report - Laura

- Mahoodfest - May 28th 2026, 5:30-7:30
- Lions Bingo night - April 23rd, 2026
- Setting fundraising goal for the year, in past years we have chosen a theme
- Regular spending items budgeting:

    - Pancake Day: $200
    - Holiday rotation day hot chocolate: $125
    - Jump Rope for heart freezies / track and field freezies: $50 each
    - Kindie concert: $125
    - **Motion to spend $550 on the above listed expenditures by Laura, seconded by Stephanie - Passed by Majority vote**
- Classroom allowance spending - last year we provided $300 per class (21 classrooms)
    - Idea, make a separate allowance for field trips and a separate allowance for classroom supplies
    - Idea, per child allowance for “experiential learning”. (field trips, presentations, experiments, etc) 439 +/- students
    - **Motion to allow spending of up to $6600 ($15/student) to be used for experiential learning by Laura, seconded by Bethany - passed by majority vote**
    - Re-visit classroom spending amount once we have an idea of what the bridge may cost
- Extra activities that all students can participate in
    - Saidat classes: leadership, dance, culture workshops
    - Nutrition presentations
    - **Motion to spend up to $2000 for Saidat show by Laura, seconded Bethany - passed by majority vote**
- Skating party - last year spent $700+
    - Was very popular last year
    - Bethany will look into dates
- Jungle sport last year - teacher request not to do it again, spend the money elsewhere
- Playground - last year the dragon was damaged and cannot be replaced
    - Kids still enjoy it, and the sand pit - no need to replace it
- Bridge was broken last year, has become a safety issue - request to fix or replace the bridge
    - Linda to look into it, speak with facilities
    - If previously purchased by council, it will be a council expense
- Supporting teams and clubs, like knitting clubs etc
- **Fundraising theme for the 2025/2026 school year: student achievement and community engagement**

Treasury Report - Katie

- See Treasurers Report
- Started Sept 2024 with ~$13,000
- Ended June 2025 with ~$12,000

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- Raised ~$15,000 through fundraising
- This year starting with $12,595

Teachers Report - Christine

- Recess great feedback
- Terry fox picnic Friday Sept. 26
- Thank-you for coming out to meet the teacher
- Get a police check for volunteering within the school - must be vulnerable sector check
    - wrdsb.ca governance volunteer policy, application process
    - Linda to keep a list

Social Media Report - Katie

- Connect more with fundraising committee to plan posts ahead
- After each meeting, make a plan in advance of what's coming up in the month
- Add a post for pizza volunteers
- Terry Fox family picnic

Fundraising & Community Engagements - Emily

- Pre-booked items
    - Poinsettias / Baden coffee - merge these fundraisers for end of November
        - Baden coffee is booked, Emily to book poinsettias
        - Sell mid-end october
    - Candy Fundraiser - delicious and popular
        - New last year
        - Booked for valentines day

Open Discussion - All

- Mascot - revisit the idea of purchasing
    - Jolt the Jaguar was about character improvement
- School fundraising (separate from council)
    - Grade six - pitas, popcorn, harveys
    - Food drive
    - Winter clothing drive

Next meeting

- October 16th, 2025 at 6:30 in school library
- November 20th, 2025
- ~~December 18th, 2025~~
- January 15th 2026

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- February 19th, 2026
- ~~March 19th, 2026~~
- April 16th, 2026
- May 21st, 2026

Meeting adjourned 8:08pm

***Revisions:**

- Mary Blanchard was missed in the attendance
- Natalie Anglin has decided not to join as a voting member this year
- There will be no meeting in December or March